[Metric]
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COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
PENCIL, GENERAL WRITING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. Scope. This Commercial Item Description covers wood, paper or plastic lead cased pencils some of which have recycled materials and are used as a marking medium on paper.

2. Classification:

Type:	I.	Wood Cased
	II.	Paper Cased (Recycled)
	III.	Plastic Cased (Recycled)

3. Salient Characteristics:

3.1 Type I wood cased pencils shall be provided with black lead with diameters as specified in table I. The length of the pencil shall be not less than 16.98 cm (6.685 inches) excluding the eraser. The casing shall be round or hexagonally shaped. The finish shall be either colored lacquer with a non-offensive odor, natural, or rubberized and in conformance with normal commercial practice as specified in the contract or order.

3.2 Type II paper cased pencils shall contain recycled materials in accordance with paragraph 4.2. The pencil leads shall be black lead with diameters as specified in table I. The length of the pencil shall be not less than 16.98 cm (6.685 inches) not including the eraser. The casing shall be round or hexagonally shaped. The finish shall have a non-offensive odor with a colored lacquer coating, natural or rubberized and in conformance with normal commercial practice as specified in the contract or order.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Division, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7510

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3.3 Type III plastic case pencils shall contain recycled materials in accordance with paragraph 4.1. The pencil leads shall be black lead with diameters as specified in table I. The length of the pencil shall be not less than 16.98 cm (6.685 inches) excluding the eraser. The casing shall be round or hexagonally shaped. The finish shall have a non-offensive odor with a colored lacquer coating, natural or rubberized and in conformance with normal commercial practice as specified in the contract or order.

3.4 The eraser shall be in accordance with the latest revision of Commercial Item Description A-A-132 for the eraser type normally used for the type pencil specified. The eraser shall be crimped or otherwise attached to the casing, by use of a metal or plastic collar.

3.5 The pencils shall produce marks normally made by pencils, when used on paper. Marks shall be smudge resistant, shall reproduce clearly and shall erase cleanly without ghosting when using a pencil type rubber eraser, artgum eraser or plastic film eraser.

3.6 The leads shall be continuously smooth marking, and shall not crumble or chip, and shall be of such strength and resilience so as to reduce breakage when used properly.

3.7 The hardness and diameters of the leads shall be expressed as a **"grade"** as defined by ASTM C709 and designated in accordance with table I. below:

Table I.

Degree of Hardness	Lead Diameter Range
No. 1, Extra Soft	.236 cm to .291 cm (0.093 to 0.115 inches)
No. 2, Soft	.205 cm to .241 cm (0.081 to 0.095 inches)
No. 3, Hard	.190 cm to .210 cm (0.075 to 0.083 inches)

3.7.1 Hardness of the lead shall be such that no inversion shall take place as the density increases from soft to hard for the leads of the same brand. The grades and lack of inversions shall be certified by the vendor to be in conformance with normal commercial practice. The evidence of this conformance shall be available to the government in the form of a chart of line densities for the full range of grades, upon request.

3.8 Leads shall be centered and securely bonded (glued) within the casing throughout the entire length of the pencil. Leads shall be continuously smooth marking, provide clearly visible lines and not crumble or dust.

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3.9 Pencils shall be marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark, hardness of lead provided and other normal commercial markings shall be acceptable. The color of the case shall also be in accordance with normal commercial practice.

3.10 Workmanship. Pencils shall be free from defects which may affect the serviceability or appearance.

4. **Regulatory Requirements:** The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

4.1 Certification: The contractor shall certify that if polystyrene is used in the manufacture of the item, it shall contain a minimum of 25 percent Postconsumer Recovered Materials in accordance with the 40 Code of Federal Regulations Part 247, Comprehensive Guideline for Procurement of Products Containing Recovered Materials; final rule. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provision of the contract.

4.2 Type II pencils shall contain a minimum of 45 % by weight recycled raw materials, 40 % of which are post-consumer recovered materials. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provision of the contract.

5. **Quality Assurance Requirements:**

5.1 Product Conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Examination and Testing.

5.2.1 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. (Statistical Process Control) SPC Techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. If used, objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein.

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5.2.2 End item inspection/testing may be used by the offeror or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. While in process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing they may be used in lieu of visual and dimensional inspections.

5.2.3 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection shall be required. The sample unit shall be one pencil. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

5.2.4 An inspection lot shall consist of all like items submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level for visual, and dimensional shall be S-1 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The inspection level for performance testing shall be S-4 with a AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above.

5.3 Tests.

5.3.1 Diameter of Lead. Measurements shall be taken at three points (near each end, and the middle) of each specimen. The mean of the three measurements shall determine the conformance of the specimen.

6. Packaging:

6.1 Preservation, packing, and marking shall be specified in the contract or order.

7. Notes:

7.1 Source of Documents. Issues of the following documents, in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

7.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

7.1.2 Application for copies of (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 and (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 may be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control. PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

7.1.3 Copies of the appropriate ASTM's may be obtained from the American Standards for Testing Materials at 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

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7.1.4 Federal Standards and Specifications may be obtained from the General Services Administration Specifications Section (3FBO-W) in Suite 8100 at 490 L'Enfant Plaza, SW Washington DC 20407.

7.2 National Stock Number Listing (NSN). The following is a list of Nsn's assigned which correspond to this CID. The list may not be indicative of all possible Nsn's associated with the CID.

7510-00-281-5234
7510-00-281-5235
7510-00-286-5757
7510-01-357-8952
7510-01-386-2265

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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